

The 12-bar blues map every chord option in 18 forms, simplest first

Key of B♭, concert pitch

Bars 1–4
I, or something
standing in for it

B♭7	1
B♭Δ	I7 1–9
B– E7	IIΔ7 10–15 17
F–/B♭	#i–7 #IV7 16 I9sus 18

B♭7	2
E♭7	IV7 3–9
A– A♭–	vii–7 ♭vii–7 11
E♭Δ	IVΔ7 12 13
A– D7	vii–7 III7 10 14–16
B– E7	#i–7 #IV7 17
B♭–/E♭	IV9sus 18

B♭7	3
G– G♭–	vi–7 ♭vi–7 11
D– C–	iii–7 ii–7 12 13
G– C7	vi–7 II7 10 14–16
AΔ A♭Δ	VIIΔ7 ♭VIIΔ7 17
F–/B♭	I9sus 18

B♭7	4
F– B♭7	v–7 I7 7–10 14 16
F– E7	v–7 #IV7 11
B– E7	#i–7 #IV7 12 13 15
G♭Δ EΔ	♭VIIΔ7 #IVΔ7 17
F–/B♭	I9sus 18

Bars 5–8
IV, then back
toward I

E♭7	5
E♭Δ	IV7 1–10
B♭–/E♭	IV9sus 18

E♭7	6
A♭7	♭VII7 6–8
E°	#iv°7 10
E♭–	iv–7 11 12
E– A7	#iv–7 VII7 9 17
E♭– A♭7	iv–7 ♭VII7 13 14 16
E♭– A7	iv–7 VII7 15
B♭–/E♭	IV9sus 18

B♭7	7
B♭7 A7	I7 VII7 9
D– G7	iii–7 VI7 10
D–	iii–7 8 11 12 14 15
D♭Δ	♭IIIΔ7 13 16
DΔ	IIIΔ7 17
F–/B♭	I9sus 18

B♭7	8
G7	VI7 4–6 8
A♭7 G7	♭VII7 VI7 9
D♭–	♭iii–7 11 12
D– G7	iii–7 VI7 7 17
D♭– G♭7	♭iii–7 ♭VI7 10 13–16
F–/B♭	I9sus 18

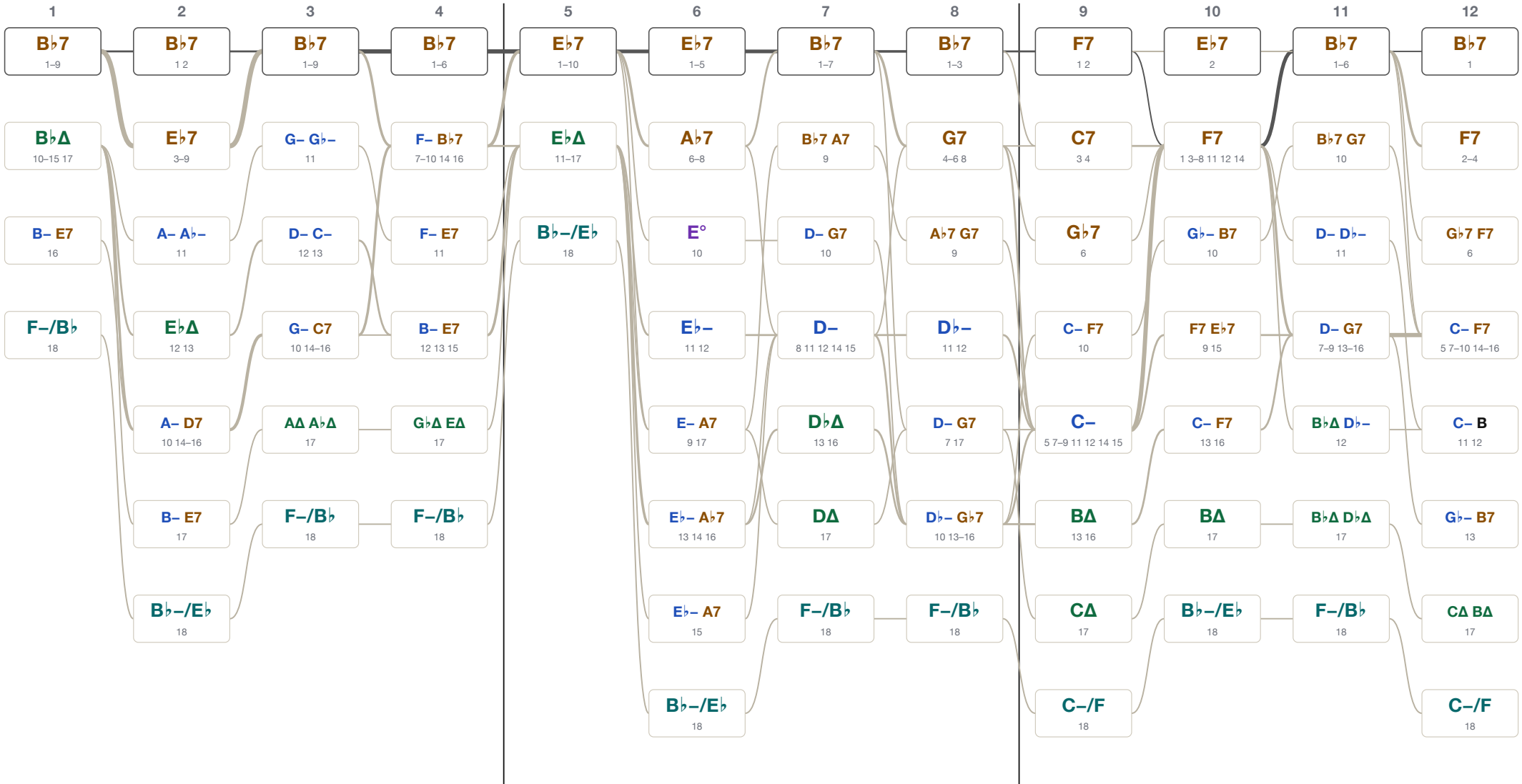
Bars 9–12
V (or a ii–V),
home to I

F7	9
C7	V7 1 2
G♭7	♭VI7 3 4
C– F7	ii–7 V7 6
C–	ii–7 5 7–9 11 12 14 15
BΔ	♭IIΔ7 13 16
CΔ	IIΔ7 17
C–/F	V9sus 18

E♭7	10
F7	V7 1 3–8 11 12 14
G♭– B7	♭vi–7 ♭II7 10
F7 E♭7	v7 IV7 9 15
C– F7	ii–7 V7 13 16
BΔ	♭IIΔ7 17
B♭–/E♭	IV9sus 18

B♭7	11
B♭7 G7	I7 VI7 10
D– D♭–	iii–7 ♭iii–7 11
D– G7	iii–7 VI7 7–9 13–16
B♭Δ D♭–	IΔ7 ♭iii–7 12
B♭Δ D♭Δ	IΔ7 ♭IIIΔ7 17
F–/B♭	I9sus 18

B♭7	12
F7	V7 2–4
G♭7 F7	♭VI7 V7 6
C– F7	ii–7 V7 5 7–10 14–16
C– B	ii–7 ♭II 11 12
G♭– B7	♭vi–7 ♭II7 13
CΔ BΔ	IIΔ7 ♭IIΔ7 17
C–/F	V9sus 18



The 18 forms

bold: changed from the row above

Key of B♭, concert pitch

Form	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
1 Basic blues	B♭7	B♭7	B♭7	B♭7	E♭7	E♭7	B♭7	B♭7	F7	F7	B♭7	B♭7
2 V–IV cadence	B♭7	B♭7	B♭7	B♭7	E♭7	E♭7	B♭7	B♭7	F7	E♭7	B♭7	F7
3 Quick four + II7	B♭7	E♭7	B♭7	B♭7	E♭7	E♭7	B♭7	B♭7	C7	F7	B♭7	F7
4 VI7–II7–V7 chain	B♭7	E♭7	B♭7	B♭7	E♭7	E♭7	B♭7	G7	C7	F7	B♭7	F7
5 Diatonic ii–V	B♭7	E♭7	B♭7	B♭7	E♭7	E♭7	B♭7	G7	C–	F7	B♭7	C– F7
6 IV of IV + tritone subs	B♭7	E♭7	B♭7	B♭7	E♭7	A♭7	B♭7	G7	G♭7	F7	B♭7	G♭7 F7
7 ii–V into IV; iii–VI–ii–V	B♭7	E♭7	B♭7	F– B♭7	E♭7	A♭7	B♭7	D– G7	C–	F7	D– G7	C– F7
8 iii– in bar 7	B♭7	E♭7	B♭7	F– B♭7	E♭7	A♭7	D–	G7	C–	F7	D– G7	C– F7
9 Chromatic dominants	B♭7	E♭7	B♭7	F– B♭7	E♭7	E– A7	B♭7 A7	A♭7 G7	C–	F7 E♭7	D– G7	C– F7
10 Bird blues	B♭Δ	A– D7	G– C7	F– B♭7	E♭7	E°	D– G7	D♭– G♭7	C– F7	G♭– B7	B♭7 G7	C– F7
11 Chromatic minor sevenths	B♭Δ	A– A♭–	G– G♭–	F– E7	E♭Δ	E♭–	D–	D♭–	C–	F7	D– D♭–	C– B
12 Major sevenths + chromatic minors	B♭Δ	E♭Δ	D– C–	B– E7	E♭Δ	E♭–	D–	D♭–	C–	F7	B♭Δ D♭–	C– B
13 ii–Vs to ♭III and ♭II	B♭Δ	E♭Δ	D– C–	B– E7	E♭Δ	E♭– A♭7	D♭Δ	D♭– G♭7	BΔ	C– F7	D– G7	G♭– B7
14 Blues for Alice style	B♭Δ	A– D7	G– C7	F– B♭7	E♭Δ	E♭– A♭7	D–	D♭– G♭7	C–	F7	D– G7	C– F7
15 Tritone-sub ii–V into IV	B♭Δ	A– D7	G– C7	B– E7	E♭Δ	E♭– A7	D–	D♭– G♭7	C–	F7 E♭7	D– G7	C– F7
16 ii–V chain from bar 1	B– E7	A– D7	G– C7	F– B♭7	E♭Δ	E♭– A♭7	D♭Δ	D♭– G♭7	BΔ	C– F7	D– G7	C– F7
17 Major-seventh planing	B♭Δ	B– E7	AΔ A♭Δ	G♭Δ EΔ	E♭Δ	E– A7	DΔ	D– G7	CΔ	BΔ	B♭Δ D♭Δ	CΔ BΔ
18 Sus-chord blues	F–/B♭	B♭–/E♭	F–/B♭	F–/B♭	B♭–/E♭	B♭–/E♭	F–/B♭	F–/B♭	C–/F	B♭–/E♭	F–/B♭	C–/F